Extracorporeal Life Support – Section Summary

VV/VA-ECMO • Lung rest • Harlequin • Flow problems

Critical Care Board Review • Section 34 • MCQ-Oriented

1. Key Points

- Poor oxygenation on VV → **TEE** cannula flow (recirculation)
- On ECMO: continue **ultra-protective ventilation** (VT 4 mL/kg, PEEP 10, low FiO_2)
- Femoral VA + recovering LV + poor lungs → **north–south (Harlequin) syndrome**
- Chattering lines/low flow → **hypovolaemia**

2. High-Yield MCQ Pearls

- [x] VA-ECMO: check right radial gas
- [x] Chattering = hypovolaemia

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